

Northwind Robotics

Employee Handbook, 2026 Edition

This handbook explains how we work at Northwind Robotics: our leave policy, remote work rules, expense process, equipment, and how to raise concerns. It applies to all full-time employees. Policies take effect on January 1, 2026 and are reviewed every year by the People Team.

1. Working Hours and Remote Work

Our core hours are 10:00 AM to 4:00 PM local time, Monday to Friday. Outside core hours, employees may choose their own schedule as long as they complete 40 hours per week.

Employees may work remotely up to 3 days per week. Teams meet in the office every Tuesday and Thursday for planning sessions. Employees who want to work fully remotely must get written approval from their department head and the People Team.

Northwind provides a home office stipend of \$600 once every two years. The stipend can be used for a desk, chair, monitor, or similar equipment. Receipts must be submitted within 30 days of purchase.

2. Leave and Holidays

Every full-time employee receives 24 days of paid vacation per year, plus 10 company holidays. Unused vacation can be carried over, up to a maximum of 5 days, into the next calendar year. Any days above that limit expire on March 31.

Sick leave is separate from vacation. Employees receive 12 paid sick days per year. A doctor's note is required only when sick leave lasts more than 3 consecutive days.

Parental leave is 18 weeks of fully paid leave for the primary caregiver and 8 weeks for the second caregiver. Leave can start up to 4 weeks before the expected birth or adoption date.

3. Expenses and Travel

Business expenses are reimbursed within 14 days of approval. Submit every expense through the Finance Portal with a receipt. Expenses without receipts are not reimbursed, except for items under \$10.

Flights must be booked at least 14 days in advance and in economy class. Flights longer than 6 hours may be booked in premium economy with manager approval. Hotels are capped at the nightly rates below.

City type	Hotel limit per night	Meal allowance per day
Major cities (e.g. London, New York)	\$260	\$75
Other cities	\$180	\$60
International, outside Europe and US	\$220	\$65

Client dinners require prior approval from a director when the total exceeds \$200. Alcohol is reimbursed only at client events.

4. Equipment and Security

Every new employee receives a company laptop on their first day. Laptops are replaced every 3 years. Lost or stolen devices must be reported to the IT team within 24 hours. All laptops use full-disk encryption, and employees must enable two-factor authentication on every work account.

Passwords must be at least 14 characters long and must never be shared. Confidential customer data may only be stored on approved company systems, never on personal drives or messaging apps.

5. Performance Reviews and Growth

Performance reviews happen twice a year, in June and December. Each employee sets three goals with their manager at the start of the year. Promotion decisions are made in December and take effect on February 1.

Every employee has a learning budget of \$1,500 per year for courses, books, and conferences. Unused budget does not roll over. Employees who attend a conference are expected to share a short summary with their team within two weeks.

6. Resignation and Notice

Employees who resign must give 60 days of written notice. During the notice period, the company may ask the employee to hand over projects and train a successor. Northwind may shorten the notice period at its discretion. Unused vacation is paid out on the final day of employment.

7. Raising Concerns

Anyone can report a concern about harassment, safety, or ethics to their manager, the People Team at people@northwind.example, or the anonymous Ethics Line at 1-800-555-0142. Northwind does not tolerate retaliation against anyone who raises a concern in good faith. The People Team acknowledges every report within 2 business days.